

Jewelry & Accessories Line

Turn small batches of cured resin into wearable pieces — earrings, pendants, and rings — with safe inclusions, real hardware, and a clean, snag-free edge every time.

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SECTION 1

Small-Mold Basics for Jewelry

By the end of this section you'll know which molds work for jewelry-scale pieces and how to pour them without trapping air.

Jewelry pieces are small, which means two things work against you: tiny air bubbles are way more visible, and small cavities trap air more easily than big ones. The fix is slower pours and a few extra minutes of patience, not special equipment.

Step by step

- 1 Pick the right mold family.** Flexible silicone molds made for jewelry (bezel trays, cabochon shapes, open-back pendant blanks, ring blanks) release easier than deep craft molds because the walls are thin and flex outward.
- 2 Mix a small batch and let it rest.** Mix your resin and hardener in the ratio printed on your resin's label (most art resins are 1:1 by volume, but follow the exact ratio on YOUR resin's label — ratios vary by brand). Let the mixed resin sit in the cup for 2-3 minutes before pouring; this gives surface bubbles from mixing time to rise and pop before they end up in the mold.
- 3 Pour low and slow.** Pour in a thin, steady stream from close to the mold surface instead of dropping it in from height — height whips extra air into the resin.
- 4 Pass a heat source over the top.** A few quick passes with a kitchen torch or a hair dryer on low pop the remaining surface bubbles. Keep a torch moving constantly and a couple of inches (5 cm) away so you warm the surface, not scorch it.
- 5 Cover and walk away.** Tent a box or bowl over the piece while it cures to keep dust and stray hairs out — dust is far more obvious on a one-inch (2.5 cm) pendant than on a large tray.



Do it this way

Warm your bottles of resin and hardener in a bowl of warm (not hot) water for a few minutes before mixing. Thinner resin releases bubbles on its own much faster, which matters most on small, detailed pours.

Common mistake

Working in a cold room. Below roughly 65°F (18°C), resin thickens, traps bubbles, and can cure cloudy or tacky. Mix and cure in a space closer to 70-75°F (21-24°C) with steady airflow and no direct fan blowing dust around.

MOLD TYPE	BEST FOR	RELEASE DIFFICULTY
Open-back bezel / pendant tray	Pendants with a flat backing	Easy — no release needed
Deep silicone cabochon mold	Domed earrings, rings	Easy, flexes free
Multi-cavity earring sheet mold	Making matching pairs fast	Easy, pop out one at a time

MOLD TYPE	BEST FOR	RELEASE DIFFICULTY
Hard custom mold (your own cast)	One-of-a-kind shapes	Needs a release agent — see Mold Mastery

SECTION 2

Safe Inclusions That Hold Up

By the end of this section you'll know which inclusions are safe to embed in jewelry resin and how to prep them so they don't float, fade, or rot.

Jewelry inclusions get worn close to skin and seen up close, so the bar is higher than for a decor piece: everything you embed has to be bone-dry, flat enough to sit under a thin pour, and stable enough not to discolor over months of wear.

Step by step

- 1 Dry-press real botanicals first.** Flowers and leaves must be fully pressed and dried for at least 1-2 weeks (a flower press or a heavy book works) before they go anywhere near resin. Any trapped moisture turns into a cloudy halo or a brown rot spot months later.
- 2 Seal delicate botanicals.** Brush a very thin coat of a dedicated resin "pre-seal" or a thin layer of your resin itself over pressed flowers and let it cure before the final pour. This locks in color and stops the petal from absorbing resin and going translucent.
- 3 Choose inert, non-reactive extras.** Metal leaf (gold, silver, copper flake), fine glitter rated for resin use, mica powder, and small dried botanicals are the safest bets. Avoid fresh (non-dried) plant matter, anything oily, and loose craft glitter not labeled resin-safe — it can bleed color or react.
- 4 Build in thin layers for anything that floats.** Pour a thin base layer, let it go tacky (not fully cured — check your resin's working time), place your inclusion, then flood with a thin cap layer. This "pin" layer keeps light botanicals and flakes from drifting to one side.
- 5 Keep metal findings out of the pour.** Never embed uncoated base-metal findings directly in the resin bed — set those after curing (see Section 3). Only decorative metal leaf or flakes go inside the resin itself.



Safety first

When you sand or trim cured inclusion pieces, you're sanding resin dust, not just the botanical — wear a dust mask or respirator rated for fine particulates, work in a ventilated space, and wipe surfaces down afterward instead of blowing the dust around.

Checklist: before you embed anything

- ☐ Botanical is fully dried and pressed flat (no soft or green spots)
- ☐ Metal leaf, glitter, or mica is labeled safe for resin use
- ☐ Nothing oily, fresh, or still slightly damp is going into the mold
- ☐ You have a plan for layering so lightweight pieces don't float to one side

SECTION 3

Findings & Hardware

By the end of this section you'll know how to turn a cured resin blank into a piece someone can actually wear.

Findings are the metal connector pieces — jump rings, earring hooks, bails, ring blanks — that turn a resin shape into jewelry. Attaching them is almost always a drilling-and-gluing job, not something you set into the resin itself.

Step by step

- 1 Choose a finding material that won't react with skin.** Stainless steel, titanium, or plated hypoallergenic findings are the safest default choices for earring hooks and anything touching skin for hours.
- 2 Drill, don't embed, for pendants.** Mark a hole roughly 1/16 in (1.5-2 mm) from the top edge, then drill slowly with a small bit at low speed, backed by scrap wood, to avoid cracking the resin. Embedding a jump ring loop directly in the pour works too, but drilling after curing gives you more control over placement.
- 3 Glue bails and settings with the right adhesive.** Use a gel-formula cyanoacrylate ("super glue") or a two-part epoxy made for metal-to-resin bonds — not a general craft glue, which won't hold under daily wear and movement.
- 4 Let bonds cure fully before wearing.** Give glued findings the full cure time on that adhesive's label (often 24 hours) before the piece goes on a chain or gets handled.
- 5 Finish with jump rings and clasps last.** Attach jump rings with two pairs of pliers (one to hold, one to twist) instead of pulling them open sideways — twisting keeps the ring round and strong.



Do it this way

Keep a small parts box with jump rings, earring hooks, and bails sorted by size — matching hardware to a finished piece is faster when you're not hunting through one big jar.

FINDING	TYPICAL USE	ATTACH BY
Jump ring	Connecting a pendant to a chain or bail	Drilled hole + pliers
Earring hook / stud post	Earrings	Glued to flat-back blank
Bail	Pendants without a drilled hole	Glued to the back
Adjustable ring blank	Rings	Glued to a flat resin cabochon

SECTION 4

Finishing: Sanding, Polishing & Sealing the Edge

By the end of this section you'll know how to take a cured piece from "rough mold edge" to a smooth, comfortable, gift-ready finish.

The edge is what separates jewelry people are proud to wear from jewelry that gets left in a drawer. A rough or sharp mold line against skin is the single biggest giveaway of a rushed piece.

Step by step

- 1 Confirm the piece is fully cured first.** Sand only once your resin has reached its full cure time on the label — sanding tacky resin just smears it and clogs your sandpaper.
- 2 Wet-sand in rising grits.** Work from a coarser grit (around 400) up through 800, 1200, and 2000, keeping the piece and sandpaper wet with water the whole time. Wet sanding keeps resin dust from going airborne and keeps the surface from overheating.
- 3 Protect yourself while you sand.** Wear nitrile gloves (not latex — resin degrades latex) and safety glasses, and sand over running water or a wet paper towel so dust stays wet, not airborne.
- 4 Buff to a shine.** Finish with a plastic/acrylic polishing compound on a soft cloth or buffing wheel at low speed, working in small circles.
- 5 Do a final wipe and inspect.** Wipe with a lint-free cloth and hold the piece up to a light to check for leftover scratches, sanding haze, or a missed rough spot on the back edge where it touches skin.



Common mistake

Skipping straight to a high grit. Jumping from a rough mold line straight to 2000-grit paper just polishes the scratches instead of removing them — work through each grit in order.

Checklist: ready to sell or gift

- ☐ Piece sanded wet through at least three rising grits
- ☐ Edge is smooth to the touch, no sharp mold line
- ☐ Findings are glued, fully cured, and secure when gently tugged
- ☐ Piece has had its full cure time before being worn or packaged

A quick note on pricing: finished small resin jewelry (earrings, pendants) with hand-set inclusions and polished edges often sells in a range of roughly \$12-\$35 per piece on marketplaces like Etsy, depending on complexity

and local demand — this is a rough estimate to help you set a starting price, not a guaranteed number for your own shop.

Next Step

Open **Home Decor Collection** next. You'll take the same safe-mixing and finishing skills from this course and scale them up to bigger pieces — coasters, trays, and resin art panels — along with how to manage heat buildup in a larger pour.